Chicago EdTech Leaders Summit 2025

Post-event report | February 16 to February 17, 2025 | Chicago | in-person education event | Venue: Lakeshore Conference Center

1. Executive summary

The Chicago EdTech Leaders Summit 2025 welcomed 488 attendees out of 604 confirmed registrations (653 registrations in total), a show-up rate of 81%. Attendees rated the program 3.92 out of 5 on average, for a net promoter score of 1. 8 sponsors took part; 6 of them met their lead target, and sponsors collected 744 leads against a combined target of 620. The event cost $202,000 against a budget of $192,000 (+5.2%).

2. Audience

The largest attendee groups were Teacher (95), Professor (83), EdTech Specialist (82). Most attendees came from United States (70%), Canada (9%), Germany (5%).

3. Program highlights

The program ran 28 sessions. The highest-rated sessions were Inclusion with Wen Evans (rated 4.71, 109 attendees); Assessment with Nikhil Hughes (rated 4.67, 80 attendees); Inclusion with Priya Young (rated 4.58, 90 attendees). The lowest-rated session was Higher Ed with Rafael Okafor (rated 1.80). A highlight of the event: speed-mentoring sessions were fully booked within an hour.

4. Venue and operations

The main operational issue was that signage to the level 2 breakout rooms confused attendees. In response, volunteers were posted at the escalators and new floor decals were added.

5. Sponsor results

Sponsor	Package	Leads	Target	Attainment
Copperleaf Press	Title Sponsor	192	145	132%
Corvid Medical	Title Sponsor	185	145	128%
Cedarline Capital	Premier Booth	136	90	151%
Polarion Partners	Premier Booth	69	90	77%
Granite Learning	Standard Booth	52	50	104%
Tidewater Press	Exhibitor Table	40	25	160%
Indigo Learning	Standard Booth	37	50	74%
Juniper Capital	Exhibitor Table	33	25	132%

Sponsor feedback: Tidewater Press asked for a speaking slot in the main track next year.

6. Lessons learned

Lesson: booth traffic dropped sharply after lunch. Recommendation for the next edition: move the expo hall next to the coffee stations so attendees pass the booths between sessions.